

DigiPick of the month

"Cyber" Cafe



Last month's
winner is

Ankit Agarwalla
Guwahati
Assam

Participate and win next month
Administering Data Centers
by Kailash Jayaswal

Published by
WILEY-INDIA

WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject 'DigiPick' and your postal address on or before the 20th of this month to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

"GET A MAC"

Sure We're Convinced!

Oh, this is fun! There's ads out there advocating the purchase of Apple Macintosh computers. It's all listed out point-wise, and specifically written to <sarcasm> entice the poor, long-term, deluded Windows addict. </sarcasm>. Head over to www.apple.com/getamac.

There's no way to comment on the ad but to dissect each of the points—at least the more hilarious ones—one by one.

"#1: It just works. How much time have you spent troubleshooting your PC?"

<Smug> Not much, really. </smug> OK, OK, 98 was bad, but you don't need to keep reminding us.

"#2: You can make amazing stuff. Every Mac

comes with iLife '06, a suite of software that transforms your photos, music, and video into all kinds of projects."

Yeah again. Like you don't get software suites for Windows that "transform" our photos and videos into "all kinds of projects," whatever that's supposed to mean.

"#3: Design that turns heads. You don't want to hide your Mac in a corner of the den."

Like we hide our PCs, you narcissistic show-offs!

"#4. 114,000 Viruses? Not on a Mac."

Ah, this is an advertising gem—a superior example of twisting the thought process! The line makes it sound like all 114,000 are on the bloody PC at the same time! Don't you get it?

The list goes on, and we won't deign to get indignant at each of them. But then, there's this:

"All those reasons you never bought a Mac? Not

true anymore."

"#1. Know iTunes? You know the Mac."

Sure. And we don't like iTunes, by the way.

"#3. Yes, Macs run Microsoft Office. Microsoft Office for Mac OS X gives you Word, PowerPoint, and Excel, all with familiar features and the same shortcut commands."

Hey, who is this ad for anyway?

MINESWEEPER FOR VISTA...

Fun, Games, And Geo- politics

It might be a touch insensitive to say it, because it involves people getting killed, but this is a hilarious one! It's about how and why Microsoft is going about revamping the Minesweeper game for Vista. They've changed the look and all, but they want to make it more globally friendly. (That's where "geopolitics" comes in.) This, of course, is in the spirit of the new-age things that began in the '90s, such as calling handicapped "challenged," and all that kind of stuff. Only, Microsoft is making too much of an issue of it.

According to Dave Vronay, research manager for the Windows User Experience Compliance group, Microsoft has received many complaints about Minesweeper over the years. Here's a sample:

"For those of us living in North America, land mines are an abstract

People Who Changed Computing

The Sketchpad Whiz

Ever wondered who took us beyond the command prompt? It was Ivan Sutherland, considered by many to be the



Ivan Sutherland

creator of computer graphics. The first graphics program was Sketchpad; Sutherland

developed it as part of his PhD thesis at MIT. Sketchpad made it possible to create graphic images directly on the display screen using a handheld object such as a light pen. The program went on to influence the development of the GUI!

For this invention and for related work, Sutherland received the Turing Award in 1988: that award is something like the Nobel Prize in computing.

Sutherland had learnt to program a computer when he was in high school—a rarity in his time. A multi-faceted genius, he also dabbled in IC design. There's more: with the help of Bob Sproull, Sutherland created the first Virtual Reality and Augmented Reality Head Mounted Display in 1988.

Former employees of his company—Evans and Sutherland, which did some ground-breaking work in 3D hardware—included names like John Warnock and Jim Clark—who would then go on to found Adobe and Silicon Graphics respectively!

Sutherland is currently a vice president and Fellow at Sun Microsystems.